satisfactory completion of schoolwork and is, academically, of no greater value than a Bachelor of Arts. Nevertheless, in a medical school, those with no more than a Ph.D. are second-class citizens. I knew that, but the student's question brought it home, and the value of my academic career in my own eyes, at least as long as I was in the Medical School, declined.

Then, on February 7, I gave my first lecture—on simple lipids— and survived.

Dr. Walker was surer of my talents in this direction than I was. He had been invited to give a talk at Bates College in Lewiston, Maine. He couldn't go, but suggested they invite me, telling them I was "an interesting speaker" and "quite a colorful character." I was invited for the fourteenth.

So it was that on February 14, 1950,1 took the train to Lewiston. It

was the first time I had ever made a trip for the purpose of giving a talk, but like all my talks thus far (except the one to Pauline Bloom's group the preceding May) it was to an academic audience. And as in the case of all my talks, without exception, thus far, it was without fee.

I was met at the station, taken to Lewiston's best hotel, and fed a turkey dinner before the talk. I spoke to perhaps sixty people, and they sufficed to fill the room. I don't remember what I talked about and I didn't note it in my diary, but I did speak extemporaneously, something I have done ever since. I did say in my diary that the talk "met with roaring approval. Applause! Laughter! I laid them in the aisles."

I'm sure I did. I always have since (well, nearly always). Talking that successfully, off-the-cuff, to an audience of strangers, cured me of my panic at lecturing.

Thus, on February 12, just before the Bates lecture, I had gone to Walker with a certain worry.

"Dr. Walker," I said, "last night I dreamed I got up before the class to give my lecture and I couldn't think of a thing to say. Do you think there's something ominous in that?"

"I think there's something normal in that," he said. "We all have dreams like that. Wait till you dream that you not only can't think of a thing to say but that you're standing there naked."